

Chapter 4: Disaster Management

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers

1. What are the emergency contact numbers of the following:

(a) Police Control Room

100

(b) Fire brigade

101

(c) Ambulance

102

(d) National level single emergency number for disaster relief

108

2. What first aid will you provide in the following situations?

(a) Dog bite

First aid is some immediate aid given to a victim or patient before medical treatment is available.

1. Wash the wound with a soap solution.
2. Cover the wound with a clean and dry cloth.
3. Get a doctor's help.

(b) Scratches / Bleeding

1. Make the person sit or lie down comfortably.
2. Clean the bleeding part of the body with water.
3. Keep it above the level of the heart.

(c) Burns/scalds**a. Minor burns**

1. The injured part should be washed with water or held underwater.
2. Give the victim water to drink.
3. Clean the wounds using a cotton swab soaked in an antiseptic solution.
4. Do not apply oily ointments.
5. Cover the wound using dry dressings.

b. Serious burns

1. Give emotional support.
2. Cover the wound with sterilised cloth.
3. Remove jewellery, shoes etc. if easily possible.
4. Do not touch or burst the blisters on the skin.
5. Do not apply oily ointments.
6. Do not try to remove the cloth if it is stuck to the burnt skin.
7. If the patient is conscious give water to drink but avoid tea or coffee or other stimulating drinks. Get medical aid at once.

(d) Snakebite

1. Wash the wound with water.
2. Give emotional support to the patient.
3. Tie a cloth tightly above the wound.
4. Get immediate medical help.

(e) Sunstroke

1. Take the patient to a cool place or in the shade.
2. Sponge the whole body with cold water.
3. Place a cloth soaked in cold water on the neck.
4. Give plenty of water or liquids like sherbets to drink.
5. If the patient feels like vomiting make him prone i.e. on his/her abdomen with the head turned to one side.
6. Get medical help or shift the patient to a hospital.

3. Write the causes of the following:

(a) Floods

1. Floods is a frequently occurring natural disaster in all parts of the world.
2. Due to excessive rains in the same place, a river overflows its banks causing a flood.
3. The water drainage system in big cities falls short when there is heavy rainfall, resulting in choking of gutters and drainage lines.
4. Water overflows on to the roads and surrounding houses.

(b) Forest fires

1. Forest fire is an uncontrolled fire in a forest, pasture or grasslands due to natural or man-made causes.
2. Natural causes of forest fire can be lightning, volcanic eruptions, friction amongst branches of trees in extremely hot and dry weather.
3. Man-made causes of forest fires are clearing land by burning which sometimes goes out of control.
4. Campers and hikers sometimes leave behind a potential source of ignition like a lighted cigarette or a campfire.

(c) Landslides/building collapse

1. Landslide causes due to erosion, slope movement in the downward direction, prolonged rainfall and seepage, vibration caused by earthquakes, deforestation, river erosion.
2. Building collapses: Bad design, faulty construction, foundation failure or weak foundation, extraordinary loads, earthquakes, rampant and irregular constructions.

(d) Storms

The formation of high and low air pressure belts in the atmosphere causes changes in weather resulting in strong winds or storms.

(e) Earthquakes

1. Movements in the interior of the earth release tremendous amount of energy.
2. This causes seismic waves leading to movement of the earth's surface like tremors, shaking, cracking up.
3. Such vibrations or quaking in the earth's crust is known as earthquake.
4. Man-made causes like mining, construction of big dams can also lead to earthquakes.

4. Answer the following questions.

(a) What is meant by 'disaster'?

A sudden event that causes large-scale damage to life, property and social aspects of a nation or society is called a disaster.

(b) What are the types of disasters?

Disasters are of two types: Natural disasters and man-made disasters.

(c) What is meant by disaster management'?

Taking steps to prevent disasters, making plans to face disasters and developing the capacity for that is called disaster management.

(d) Which are the main components of disaster management?

Emergency planning and implementation of disaster management work are the main components of disaster management. Community participation is close, related to disaster management.

5. Find out about the work of a 'Sarpa-mitra'.

1. A sarpa-mitra is a friend of snakes, a person who is trained to protect, save and safeguard snakes.
2. Whenever there is a phone call from police or citizens informing the sarpa-mitras about snake sightings, they immediately rush to the situation and rescue the snake that would have been killed at the hands of people.
3. Sarpa-mitra are well trained to handle snakes by capturing them, keeping them in baskets or bags before releasing them in the wild.
4. They are in contact with the Police Department and Forest Department for rehabilitation of snakes.
5. Sarpa-mitra are also trained to perform primary first aid to snake bite victims before they are moved to hospitals.
6. Thus, the sarpa-mitra do a commendable job of saving snakes, saving human life without any monetary gains, but for sheer love of snakes.

6. Find out what a first aid kit / box contains.

1. First aid kit/box is a necessity at home, workplace, travelling, schools, etc.
2. It contains a cotton roll, sterilized dressing, a pair of scissors, Dettol or Savlon, Dettol soap, adhesive plaster, tablets like Crocin, necessary medicines – painkiller, Tincture iodine, Electrolyte powder, ear/eye drops, Potassium Permanganate crystals, Bumol ointment for cramps.

7. Suggest remedial measures for dealing with natural or man-made disasters.

1. Fire: Use a fire extinguisher. Call the fire brigade. Run to a safe exit.
2. Building collapse: Evacuate the building immediately, seek shelter in other safe places. Call the fire brigade or rescue team. First aid should be given to injured people.
3. Road accident: Call the ambulance immediately. Give first aid if possible.
4. Flood: Do not linger in houses or areas near river banks. Seek shelter in other safe places. Move to safer places at a greater height. Do not step into water currents or drive a vehicle into them.
5. War: Take shelter in relief camps. Provide assistance in the rescue mission.
6. Bomb explosions: Take shelter in relief camps/safe place. Immediately call the police. Be alert and do not touch the unattended objects.
7. Earthquakes: Run to a safe place. Hide below a table and do not use elevators. Use a staircase.
8. Deluge: Take the warnings and signals from the Meteorological Department keep away from river banks and low-lying areas. Take shelter in relief camps.
9. Storm: Remain in a safe place. Unplug all electrical devices. Take instructions given to people by meteorological department do not take shelter in dilapidated structures and under trees.
10. Tsunami: Move to a safer place, stay alert.
11. Drought: Save water, take care of people and cattle.
12. Landslide: Landslide may be caused due to excessive rains or cloudburst in hilly areas. Do not take shelter at the foot of a hill.